

GROUNDING TOOLKIT

Five ways to anchor when your nervous system feels overwhelmed

1 Sensory

- Hold a textured stone or other grounding object
- Use a cooling peppermint roller
- Notice small things you can see, hear, touch, smell, or taste
- Splash cold water on your face
- Wrap in a weighted blanket

2 Visualization

- Picture a place that is relaxing or calm
- Imagine a container for difficult feelings
- Write a list of soothing colors or light
- Picture yourself in your future calm
- Visualize a personal team of allies or helpers

3 Movement

- Take a slow, mindful walk
- Stretch your body gently
- Do 10 wall pushes
- Do a gentle back shake
- Shake out tension
- Try rhythmic movement like marching or step-touch

4 Companion/Connection

- Call or text someone you trust
- Spend time with a pet
- Call a crisis line
- Join a supportive group
- Connect through eye contact or a kind smile

5 Cognitive Cooling

- Label what you're feeling
- Challenge unhelpful thoughts
- Journal or write out thoughts
- Talk to yourself like a concerned caring friend
- Remind yourself: "This feeling is temporary."

Different tools work in different states. Practice when you're relatively regulated so they're easier to use when you need them.

Build Your Personal Kit

SENSORY _____

VISUALIZATION _____

MOVEMENT _____

COMPANION / CONNECTION _____

COGNITIVE COOLING _____